

QRU • HEALTH



TEACHER GUIDE

QRU Factory Acceptance Test — Understanding Sleep and Rest — Teacher Guide

Foundational • General public
A Sleep & Rest learning product

**QRU Factory Acceptance Test - Understanding
Sleep and Rest - Teacher Guide**

QRU PRESS™

Edition 1

TREASURE STANDARD(TM) CERTIFIED

QRU Teacher Guide - Health

QRU Factory Acceptance Test - Understanding Sleep and Rest - Teacher Guide

Manufactured by QRU Factory(TM). QRU simplifies the path to understanding the truth.

QRU Teacher Guide

Understanding Sleep and Rest

Factory Acceptance Test Edition

Product Type: Teacher Guide

Subject Area: Health / Wellness / Life Skills

Lesson Length: 45-60 minutes

Primary Audience: Teachers, facilitators, school nurses, wellness instructors, or adult education leaders teaching learners about sleep health

Learner Levels: Middle school, high school, and adult education

Essential Question: Why do humans need sleep, and can rest replace it?

QRU Core Message

Rest can pause the drain, but sleep does the repair.

Sleep is not "doing nothing." It is an active biological process that supports learning, memory, immune regulation, cardiovascular health, metabolism, emotional regulation, safety, and physical recovery.

Rest is valuable. Quiet time, relaxation, and breaks can reduce strain and improve alertness for a while. However, rest does not fully replace enough high-quality sleep.

Medical and Wellness Disclaimer

This QRU lesson is for educational purposes only. It is not medical advice and is not a substitute for diagnosis, treatment, counseling, or care from a qualified health professional.

Teachers should not attempt to diagnose insomnia, sleep disorders, mental health conditions, trauma responses, or medical concerns. Encourage learners to speak with a parent/guardian, school nurse, counselor, doctor, or other qualified professional if sleep problems are severe, ongoing, distressing, unsafe, or connected to health concerns.

1. Lesson Snapshot

Big Idea

Humans need sleep because the brain and body perform essential repair, regulation, learning, and recovery functions during sleep that cannot be fully completed during quiet rest alone.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this QRU lesson, learners will be able to:

1. Explain at least three reasons sleep is biologically essential.
2. Distinguish between sleep, rest, relaxation, quiet wakefulness, and naps.
3. Identify health, learning, mood, and safety risks linked to insufficient sleep.
4. Describe recommended sleep duration ranges by age group.
5. Name evidence-informed sleep habits that support better sleep.
6. Analyze realistic sleep-related scenarios and recommend healthier choices.
7. Recognize when sleep concerns should be discussed with a qualified health professional.
8. Create one realistic personal sleep improvement goal.

QRU Success Criteria

Learners are successful when they can say:

- "I can explain why sleep matters for my brain and body."
- "I can explain why resting is helpful but not the same as sleeping."
- "I can identify habits that may improve sleep."
- "I can choose one realistic sleep goal that fits my life."
- "I know when a sleep concern may need adult or medical support."

2. Standards and Competency Alignment

This lesson supports common health education and wellness competencies.

| Standard Area | Lesson Connection |

|---|---|

| Health Concepts | Learners explain how sleep supports brain function, immune regulation, cardiovascular health, metabolism, emotional regulation, and physical recovery. |

| Analyzing Influences | Learners examine how caffeine, technology use, light exposure, schedules, stress, caregiving, work, housing, and sleep environments affect sleep. |

| Decision-Making | Learners evaluate choices that improve or interfere with healthy sleep. |

Goal-Setting	Learners create a realistic sleep improvement plan.
Self-Management	Learners identify practical habits such as consistent sleep timing, wind-down routines, reducing evening light exposure, and asking for support when needed.
Health Advocacy	Learners recognize sleep-related symptoms that may need professional evaluation.

3. Materials Needed

Teacher Materials

- QRU Teacher Guide
- Board, projector, or chart paper
- Timer
- Scenario cards or projected scenarios
- Exit ticket copies or digital form
- Optional: sticky notes or index cards

Learner Materials

- Notebook or paper
 - Writing tool
 - QRU Sleep Goal Worksheet
 - Quick Quiz or Exit Ticket
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4. Teacher Background Knowledge

A. What Sleep Is

Sleep is a naturally recurring biological state involving changes in consciousness, brain activity, breathing, heart rate, hormone regulation, muscle tone, and recovery processes.

Sleep includes different stages, including non-REM sleep and REM sleep. Different sleep stages support different functions, including physical restoration, learning, memory, emotional processing, and brain health.

Sleep helps with:

- Brain function: attention, learning, memory consolidation, decision-making, and cognitive performance.
- Immune regulation: immune system function and response to illness.
- Cardiovascular health: blood pressure regulation and heart health.
- Metabolism: glucose regulation, appetite hormones, energy balance, and metabolic health.
- Emotional regulation: mood stability, stress response, and emotional processing.
- Safety and performance: reaction time, attention, judgment, academic/work performance, and accident risk.

B. What Rest Is - and What It Is Not

Rest means reducing activity, effort, stimulation, or stress. Rest may include sitting quietly, meditating, stretching, breathing calmly, listening to music, taking a break, or lying down while awake.

Rest can help people:

- Feel calmer
- Reduce stress
- Recover from physical or mental effort
- Improve focus for a short time
- Pause exhaustion temporarily

However:

Rest can pause the drain, but sleep does the repair.

Rest does not fully replace sleep because many important sleep processes require actual sleep stages and sleep cycles.

C. What Naps Can and Cannot Do

Naps are short periods of sleep during the day. Naps may help with alertness, mood, reaction time, and short-term performance, especially when someone is temporarily tired.

However, naps do not fully replace regular, adequate nighttime sleep. Long or late naps may also make it harder for some people to fall asleep at night.

A simple teaching point:

A nap can be a helpful "boost," but it is not a full substitute for a healthy sleep routine.

D. Recommended Sleep Duration by Age

The American Academy of Sleep Medicine and the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention recommend the following general sleep duration ranges per 24 hours:

Age Group Recommended Sleep Duration
--- ---:
4-12 months 12-16 hours, including naps
1-2 years 11-14 hours, including naps
3-5 years 10-13 hours, including naps
6-12 years 9-12 hours
13-18 years 8-10 hours
18-60 years 7 or more hours
61-64 years 7-9 hours
65 years and older 7-8 hours

Source: Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, based on American Academy of Sleep Medicine recommendations.

E. Why Sleep Problems Can Be Complex

Sleep is influenced by biology, environment, stress, safety, health, family responsibilities, culture, work, school schedules, housing, caregiving, disability, trauma, and access to healthcare.

Avoid framing sleep as only a matter of "discipline" or "good choices." Some learners may want more sleep but face barriers outside their control.

Use QRU's balanced message:

Better sleep habits can help, but not every sleep challenge is solved by habits alone. Support matters.

5. Sensitive Topic Guidance for Teachers

Sleep conversations can reveal personal, medical, family, or safety concerns. Use care.

A. Do Not Require Personal Disclosure

Learners should never be required to share:

- Their exact bedtime or wake time
- Mental health concerns

- Trauma history
- Housing situation
- Family responsibilities
- Medical conditions
- Medication use
- Household conflict
- Work schedule
- Caregiving duties

Use hypothetical examples and allow private writing.

B. Use Nonjudgmental Language

Say:

- "Many factors can affect sleep."
- "Some sleep barriers are not fully under a person's control."
- "The goal is to learn options, not blame anyone."
- "If sleep problems are ongoing or unsafe, it is okay to ask for help."

Avoid:

- "Just go to bed earlier."
- "You're lazy if you sleep late."
- "Phones are always the problem."
- "Everyone can get enough sleep if they try."
- "You must tell us why you're tired."

C. Topics That May Require Extra Care

Insomnia

Insomnia may involve difficulty falling asleep, staying asleep, or waking too early, even when someone has the opportunity to sleep. If it is ongoing or distressing, learners should be encouraged to speak with a healthcare professional.

Sleep Disorders

Sleep disorders can include sleep apnea, restless legs syndrome, narcolepsy, circadian rhythm sleep-wake disorders, parasomnias, and others. Symptoms such as loud snoring with pauses in breathing, extreme daytime sleepiness, sudden sleep episodes, or frequent sleep disruption may need professional evaluation.

Trauma and Stress

Trauma, grief, anxiety, unsafe environments, or chronic stress can affect sleep. Avoid asking learners to explain personal experiences. Offer private support pathways such as school counselor, trusted adult, nurse, or community services.

Shift Work and Irregular Schedules

Some adult learners, older students, or family members may work nights or rotating shifts. Shift work can make regular nighttime sleep difficult. Emphasize realistic strategies such as protecting sleep time, controlling light exposure when possible, and seeking support if fatigue becomes unsafe.

Housing Insecurity or Unsafe Sleep Environments

Some learners may not have a quiet, safe, private, or consistent place to sleep. Do not assume every learner has control over their sleep environment. Provide low-cost and flexible strategies, and know your school or program's referral process.

Caregiving Responsibilities

Some learners care for siblings, children, elders, or ill family members. Acknowledge that caregiving can interrupt sleep. Encourage problem-solving, support seeking, and realistic goals rather than blame.

Medical Concerns and Medication

Pain, asthma, allergies, depression, anxiety, ADHD, pregnancy, hormones, and medications can affect sleep. Teachers should not advise learners to start, stop, or change medication. Refer medical questions to qualified professionals.

D. When to Refer or Encourage Help

Encourage learners to speak with a trusted adult, school nurse, counselor, doctor, or other qualified professional if they experience:

- Sleep problems lasting several weeks or more
 - Extreme daytime sleepiness
 - Falling asleep during unsafe situations
 - Loud snoring, choking, gasping, or pauses in breathing during sleep
 - Frequent nightmares or sleep-related fear
 - Sleep problems connected to anxiety, depression, trauma, or grief
 - Sleepwalking or dangerous behaviors during sleep
 - Ongoing pain, breathing problems, or medical symptoms
 - Fatigue that interferes with school, work, driving, caregiving, or daily life
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6. Plain-Language Vocabulary Support

Use this QRU vocabulary table before or during direct instruction.

Term	Plain-Language Meaning	Example
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Sleep	A natural body state when the brain and body go through repair and regulation cycles.	Sleeping through the night.
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Rest	A break from effort, stress, or activity while awake.	Sitting quietly after a busy day.
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Relaxation	Calming the body and mind.	Deep breathing or gentle stretching.
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Nap	A short sleep during the day.	Sleeping for 20 minutes in the afternoon.
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Sleep hygiene	Habits and surroundings that support healthy sleep.	A consistent bedtime routine.
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Circadian rhythm	The body's internal clock that helps time sleep and wakefulness.	Feeling sleepy at night and alert during the day.
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REM sleep	A sleep stage linked to dreaming, memory, and emotional processing.	Dreaming during sleep.
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Non-REM sleep	Sleep stages linked to physical restoration and deep sleep.	Deep sleep after falling asleep.
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Insomnia	Ongoing trouble falling asleep, staying asleep, or waking too early.	Lying awake for hours most nights.
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Sleep debt	The gap between sleep needed and sleep actually received.	Needing 8 hours but getting 5 for several nights.
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Alertness	Being awake, focused, and able to respond.	Paying attention in class or while driving.
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7. Accessibility and Inclusion Supports

A. Universal Design Options

Provide multiple ways to participate:

- Speaking: partner discussion, small group discussion, whole group share
- Writing: private reflection, worksheet, exit ticket
- Drawing: sleep routine map or habit sketch
- Movement: stand/sit response, card sort, gallery walk
- Digital: poll, form, shared document, text response

B. Accommodations for Learners with Disabilities

Consider:

- Provide printed notes or guided notes.
- Read scenarios aloud.
- Allow speech-to-text, typing, drawing, or verbal response.
- Reduce writing load for learners with fine motor or processing challenges.
- Use captions for videos if included.
- Offer extra time for quiz, worksheet, and exit ticket.
- Allow quiet space or sensory tools.
- Avoid bright flashing slides or overstimulating media.
- Provide clear step-by-step instructions.
- Use high-contrast visuals and readable fonts.
- Check understanding privately when possible.

C. Discussion Alternatives

For learners who prefer not to speak publicly:

- Submit a private written response.
- Use anonymous sticky notes.
- Vote with cards or digital poll.
- Share with teacher only.
- Complete the scenario independently.
- Use a "pass" option during discussion.

D. Home Circumstance Sensitivity

Offer strategies that do not assume learners have:

- A private bedroom
- A quiet home
- Control over lights, noise, or temperature
- Stable housing
- A regular work or school schedule
- No caregiving responsibilities
- Easy access to healthcare
- Money for sleep products

Emphasize low-cost, flexible options:

- A consistent wind-down cue
 - Reducing bright light when possible
 - Charging devices away from the bed if possible
 - Earplugs or white noise if available and safe
 - Asking household members for a quiet window when appropriate
 - Planning caffeine cutoff times
 - Using calming breathing or stretching
 - Talking to a trusted adult or professional when sleep problems are serious
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8. Full Instructional Sequence

Lesson at a Glance

| Time | Lesson Segment | Purpose |

|---:|---|---|

| 5-7 min | Opening Activity | Activate prior knowledge and introduce the QRU core message. |

| 10-15 min | Direct Instruction | Teach sleep vs. rest, sleep functions, duration recommendations, and sleep barriers. |

| 10-12 min | Guided Practice | Analyze examples as a class or in small groups. |

| 8-10 min | Independent Practice | Complete QRU Sleep Goal Worksheet or quick scenario response. |

| 5-8 min | Discussion | Reflect on realistic sleep habits and barriers. |

| 5 min | Assessment | Complete quick quiz or exit ticket. |

| 2-3 min | Closing Reflection | Reinforce key takeaways. |

A. Opening Activity: "Can Rest Replace Sleep?"

Time: 5-7 minutes

Format: Individual quick write, poll, or partner discussion

Teacher Prompt

Display or read:

"A learner says: 'I only slept four hours, but I rested on the couch for two hours, so I'm fine.' Do you agree, disagree, or partly agree? Why?"

Learner Task

Learners respond using one of these options:

- Quick write: 3-4 sentences
- Poll: agree / disagree / partly agree
- Partner share
- Silent sticky note

Teacher Debrief

Guide learners toward the QRU core message:

Rest can pause the drain, but sleep does the repair.

Possible teacher script:

"Rest matters. It can help us feel calmer and less drained. But sleep is different. During sleep, the brain and body go through processes that support memory, recovery, hormones, immune function, emotional regulation, and safety. Today we'll learn why rest is helpful but not a full replacement for sleep."

B. Direct Instruction Notes

Time: 10-15 minutes

Use the following notes as a mini-lesson. Adapt language for age level.

1. Sleep Is Active, Not Empty Time

Teacher explanation:

"Sleep may look like doing nothing, but the brain and body are active in important ways. During sleep, the body regulates hormones, supports immune function, repairs tissues, processes emotions, and strengthens learning and memory."

Key teaching points:

- Sleep supports attention and learning.
- Sleep helps memory become more stable.
- Sleep affects mood and stress response.
- Sleep supports immune and physical recovery.
- Sleep affects metabolism and appetite regulation.
- Sleep affects safety because tired people react more slowly and make more mistakes.

2. Sleep and Rest Are Related but Not the Same

Teacher explanation:

"Rest means reducing effort or stimulation while awake. Rest is valuable, but it does not move the body through the same sleep stages as actual sleep."

| State | What It Means | What It Can Do | What It Cannot Fully Do |

|---|---|---|---|

| Sleep | A biological state with sleep stages and cycles. | Supports repair, memory, immune regulation, emotional processing, and recovery. | It is the main process the body needs; it cannot be skipped without consequences. |

| Rest | Quiet or low-effort wakefulness. | Reduces strain, stress, and mental overload. | Does not fully replace sleep cycles. |

| Relaxation | Calming the nervous system. | Helps prepare for sleep and reduce stress. | Does not equal sleep by itself. |

| Nap | Short daytime sleep. | May improve alertness and short-term performance. | Does not fully replace regular adequate nighttime sleep. |

3. Recommended Sleep Duration

Display the table:

| Age Group | Recommended Sleep Duration |

|---|---:|

| 6-12 years | 9-12 hours |

| 13-18 years | 8-10 hours |

| 18-60 years | 7 or more hours |

| 61-64 years | 7-9 hours |

| 65 years and older | 7-8 hours |

Teacher note:

"These are general recommendations. Individual needs can vary. Also, some people face barriers that make sleep difficult. This lesson is about understanding sleep and identifying supportive habits, not blaming people."

4. Common Sleep Barriers

Ask:

"What can make sleep harder?"

Possible learner responses:

- Stress
- Homework
- Phone or gaming
- Caffeine
- Noise

- Light
- Irregular schedule
- Work
- Caregiving
- Pain or illness
- Anxiety
- Unsafe or unstable housing
- Room temperature
- Sleep disorder

Teacher explanation:

"Some barriers are personal habits, and some are life circumstances. We can work on what is within our control and ask for help when a problem is bigger than a habit."

5. Sleep Hygiene Habits That May Help

Teach these as options, not guarantees.

Helpful habits may include:

- Keeping a consistent sleep and wake time when possible
- Creating a wind-down routine
- Reducing bright light and screens before bed when possible
- Avoiding caffeine late in the day
- Keeping the sleep area cool, dark, and quiet when possible
- Getting daylight exposure earlier in the day
- Moving the body during the day
- Using the bed mostly for sleep when possible
- Writing down worries or next-day tasks before bed
- Practicing calming breathing or relaxation
- Seeking help for ongoing sleep problems

Teacher clarification:

"Sleep hygiene can help, but it is not a cure for every sleep problem. Medical conditions, trauma, unsafe environments, work schedules, and caregiving responsibilities may require support beyond habits."

C. Guided Practice: QRU Scenario Analysis

Time: 10-12 minutes

Format: Whole group, pairs, small groups, or written response

Teacher Directions

Give each group one scenario or project all scenarios. Ask learners to answer:

1. What is the sleep-related issue?
 2. Is this about sleep, rest, naps, habits, barriers, or possible medical support?
 3. What is one realistic suggestion?
 4. What should we avoid saying because it may be judgmental or unhelpful?
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Scenario 1: The Couch Rest

"Jordan slept four hours because of homework. After school, Jordan lay on the couch for two hours watching videos and says, 'I rested, so my body caught up.'"

Strong Response

- Rest may help Jordan feel less drained temporarily.
- Watching videos may not be very restful if it is stimulating.
- Rest does not fully replace sleep.
- Jordan may need a plan for sleep timing, homework planning, and reducing late-night stimulation when possible.

Teacher Emphasis

Use the QRU core message:

Rest can pause the drain, but sleep does the repair.

Scenario 2: The Helpful Nap

"Maya got six hours of sleep and feels sleepy before a long evening of studying. She takes a 20-minute nap and feels more alert."

Strong Response

- A short nap may help alertness.
- The nap may support short-term performance.
- It does not fully replace regular adequate nighttime sleep.
- Maya may still need to protect her nighttime sleep schedule.

Teacher Emphasis

Naps can help, but they are not a full substitute for healthy sleep.

Scenario 3: The Shift Worker

"Alex works evenings and sometimes gets home late. Alex wants better sleep but cannot always go to bed at the same time."

Strong Response

- Work schedule is a real barrier.
- Avoid blaming Alex.
- Realistic supports may include a wind-down routine, protecting a sleep window, reducing light after work when possible, and getting support if fatigue becomes unsafe.
- If sleep problems are severe or ongoing, professional advice may help.

Teacher Emphasis

Sleep advice must fit real life.

Scenario 4: The Ongoing Sleep Problem

"Sam lies awake for hours most nights and feels exhausted during the day. This has been happening for more than a month."

Strong Response

- This may be more than a simple habit issue.
- Sam should be encouraged to speak with a trusted adult, school nurse, counselor, doctor, or qualified professional.
- Helpful habits may support sleep, but ongoing insomnia-like symptoms may require professional help.

Teacher Emphasis

Teachers should not diagnose. Refer and support.

Scenario 5: The Noisy Home

"Rina shares a room with siblings and says it is hard to sleep because the room is noisy and the lights stay on late."

Strong Response

- Rina may not control the sleep environment.
- Avoid saying, "Just make your room quiet."
- Realistic options may include asking for a quiet window, using an eye covering if safe and available, calming audio or white noise if possible, or speaking with a trusted adult.
- The goal is problem-solving without blame.

Teacher Emphasis

Healthy sleep education must be practical and compassionate.

9. Discussion Prompts

Use any 2-4 prompts depending on time.

Whole-Class or Small-Group Prompts

1. Why is sleep sometimes treated as optional, even though it is biologically important?
2. What is the difference between feeling rested and actually being fully recovered?
3. Why might someone sleep poorly even if they know good sleep habits?
4. How can technology affect sleep in helpful or harmful ways?
5. When might a nap be useful? When might it cause problems?
6. What sleep advice is realistic for a person with caregiving duties or shift work?
7. Why is it important not to shame people for being tired?
8. What is one sleep habit that many people could try without spending money?

Discussion Norms

Post or read:

- Share only what you choose to share.
 - Do not pressure others to explain personal sleep struggles.
 - Use respectful, nonjudgmental language.
 - Focus on realistic options.
 - Medical concerns should be discussed with qualified professionals, not diagnosed in class.
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10. Independent Practice

Choose Option A, B, or C.

Option A: QRU Practical Sleep Goal Worksheet

Time: 8-10 minutes

Best for: Goal-setting and personal application

Learner Directions

Complete the worksheet privately. You do not have to share personal details.

1. My Current Sleep Challenge

Check one or more that apply, or write your own.

- ? Falling asleep is hard.
- ? Staying asleep is hard.
- ? Waking up is hard.
- ? I feel tired during the day.
- ? My schedule changes a lot.
- ? Noise, light, or space makes sleep hard.
- ? Stress or worry affects my sleep.
- ? Work, school, or caregiving affects my sleep.
- ? I am not sure.
- ? Other:

2. What Is Within My Control?

Check one or two realistic options.

- ? Start a short wind-down routine.
- ? Reduce bright screens before bed when possible.
- ? Put my phone farther away from my bed when possible.
- ? Set a caffeine cutoff time.
- ? Prepare school/work items earlier.
- ? Try calming breathing or stretching.
- ? Ask for a quieter sleep window when appropriate.
- ? Get daylight earlier in the day.
- ? Keep a more consistent wake time when possible.
- ? Talk to a trusted adult or professional about ongoing sleep problems.
- ? Other:

3. My QRU Sleep Goal

Write one small, realistic goal.

This week, I will try to:

4. My Plan

When will I do it?

What might get in the way?

What is one backup plan?

5. Support

Who or what could support me?

6. Reflection

How will I know if this goal helped?

Option B: Scenario Written Response

Time: 8-10 minutes

Best for: Learners who prefer hypothetical application

Learner Directions

Choose one scenario from guided practice and answer:

1. What is the main sleep issue?
 2. What is one helpful suggestion?
 3. What is one thing you should avoid saying?
 4. When might this person need extra support?
-

Option C: Sleep Myth Check

Time: 8-10 minutes

Best for: Retrieval and misconception correction

Learner Directions

Mark each statement as True, False, or It Depends. Explain one answer.

1. Rest is exactly the same as sleep.
 2. Naps can sometimes improve alertness.
 3. Everyone has full control over their sleep schedule and sleep environment.
 4. Sleep affects learning and memory.
 5. Ongoing sleep problems may need professional support.
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11. Assessment Tools

A. QRU Quick Quiz

Time: 5 minutes

Format: Individual, partner, verbal, or digital

Questions

1. What is one way sleep supports the brain?
2. What is one way sleep supports the body?
3. True or False: Rest can fully replace sleep.
4. True or False: Naps may help alertness but do not fully replace regular adequate nighttime sleep.
5. Name one habit that may support better sleep.
6. Name one situation where a person should consider asking a qualified professional for help.
7. What is the recommended sleep range for most teenagers ages 13-18?
8. Complete the QRU core message: "Rest can pause the drain, but sleep does the ."

Answer Key

1. Accept: attention, learning, memory, decision-making, emotional processing, focus.
 2. Accept: immune function, physical recovery, cardiovascular health, metabolism, hormone regulation.
 3. False.
 4. True.
 5. Accept: consistent sleep/wake time, wind-down routine, reducing bright light/screens, avoiding late caffeine, calming routine, daylight exposure, movement during day, asking for support.
 6. Accept: ongoing insomnia, severe daytime sleepiness, breathing pauses, loud snoring with gasping, sleepwalking danger, sleep problems linked to trauma/anxiety/depression, medical symptoms, unsafe fatigue.
 7. 8-10 hours per 24 hours.
 8. Repair.
-

B. Exit Ticket

Time: 3-5 minutes

Learners answer privately.

1. One thing I learned about sleep is:
2. Rest is different from sleep because:
3. One realistic sleep-supporting habit is:
4. One question I still have is:
5. If someone has ongoing or serious sleep problems, they could:

Exit Ticket Answer Guidance

Strong responses should show that learners understand:

- Sleep is biologically active and important.
 - Rest helps but does not fully replace sleep.
 - Naps may help alertness but are not a complete substitute for regular adequate nighttime sleep.
 - Sleep habits can help, but barriers may be complex.
 - Ongoing or serious sleep concerns should be discussed with a qualified professional or trusted support person.
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C. Scenario-Response Rubric

Use this for written or spoken scenario responses.

| Criteria | 4 - Strong | 3 - Proficient | 2 - Developing | 1 - Beginning |

|---|---|---|---|

| Sleep Understanding | Clearly explains sleep/rest distinction and why sleep matters. | Explains basic sleep/rest distinction. | Shows partial understanding. | Confuses sleep, rest, and naps. |

| Practical Recommendation | Gives realistic, respectful, evidence-informed suggestion. | Gives a generally helpful suggestion. | Suggestion is vague or only partly realistic. | Suggestion is inaccurate, unsafe, or judgmental. |

| Sensitivity | Recognizes barriers and avoids blame. | Mostly respectful and nonjudgmental. | Some assumptions or limited sensitivity. | Blames or shames the person. |

| Support/Referral Awareness | Correctly identifies when professional or adult support may be

needed. | Mentions support when relevant. | Support is unclear or incomplete. | Ignores serious warning signs. |

12. Memory Reinforcement

A. QRU Key Takeaways

Post, project, or read at the end.

1. Sleep is active. The brain and body do important work during sleep.
2. Rest is helpful. It can reduce strain and calm the body.
3. Rest is not a full replacement for sleep.
4. Naps can boost alertness, but they do not fully replace regular adequate nighttime sleep.
5. Sleep affects learning, mood, health, and safety.
6. Sleep needs vary by age, and teenagers generally need 8-10 hours.
7. Sleep habits can help, but some barriers require support.
8. Ongoing or serious sleep concerns deserve professional attention.

B. Retrieval Questions

Use these at the start of the next class or as review.

1. What is the QRU core message about rest and sleep?
2. Name two body systems or functions affected by sleep.
3. What is one difference between rest and sleep?
4. What is one possible benefit of a short nap?
5. Why can't naps fully replace regular nighttime sleep?
6. What is one sleep hygiene habit?
7. What is one sleep barrier that may be outside a person's control?
8. When should someone consider talking to a qualified professional about sleep?

C. Vocabulary Review Activity

Option 1: Match

Match the term to the meaning.

| Term | Meaning |

|---|---|

- | 1. Sleep | A. A short sleep during the day |
- | 2. Rest | B. Ongoing trouble falling asleep, staying asleep, or waking too early |
- | 3. Nap | C. A biological state with sleep stages and recovery processes |
- | 4. Circadian rhythm | D. A break from effort or stimulation while awake |
- | 5. Insomnia | E. The body's internal clock |

Answer Key: 1-C, 2-D, 3-A, 4-E, 5-B

Option 2: Use It

Learners choose three terms and write one accurate sentence for each.

13. Closing Reflection

Time: 2-3 minutes

Teacher Script

"Today's QRU lesson focused on one big idea: sleep is not wasted time. It is a biological need. Rest can help us pause and recover a little, and naps can sometimes improve alertness, but neither fully replaces regular adequate sleep. Sleep supports learning, mood, health, and safety. At the same time, sleep can be affected by stress, schedules, caregiving, housing, health, and other real-life factors. Our goal is not to blame people. Our goal is to understand sleep, make realistic choices where we can, and seek support when sleep problems are bigger than habits."

Final Learner Reflection

Ask learners to complete one sentence:

- "One sleep habit I may try is?"
 - "One thing I understand differently now is?"
 - "One question I still have about sleep is?"
 - "One way I can support someone who is tired is?"
-

14. Extension Activities

A. Sleep Routine Design

Learners design a 30-minute wind-down routine using low-cost, realistic actions.

Requirements:

- At least three steps
- One technology or light-related choice
- One calming strategy
- One backup plan for a difficult night

B. Sleep and Safety Mini-Research

Learners investigate how sleep affects one safety area:

- Driving
- Sports
- Workplace safety
- Lab safety
- Medication safety
- Decision-making

Learners summarize findings in a poster, paragraph, or short presentation.

C. Myth vs. Fact Gallery Walk

Post statements around the room. Learners mark each as myth, fact, or "it depends," then revise inaccurate statements.

Suggested statements:

- "If you are lying down, your body gets everything it needs."
 - "Sleep helps memory."
 - "A short nap can sometimes help alertness."
 - "Everyone can control their sleep environment."
 - "Caffeine late in the day can affect sleep."
 - "Ongoing sleep problems may need support."
-

15. Teacher Implementation Notes

A. Pacing Suggestions

For a 45-minute lesson:

- Opening: 5 minutes
- Direct Instruction: 12 minutes

- Guided Practice: 10 minutes
- Independent Practice: 8 minutes
- Assessment: 5 minutes
- Closing: 5 minutes

For a 60-minute lesson:

- Add more scenario discussion.
- Use the full Sleep Goal Worksheet.
- Include vocabulary review.
- Conduct a short debate: "What is the most realistic sleep habit for students or working adults?"

B. Differentiation by Learner Level

Middle School

- Use simpler vocabulary.
- Focus on sleep vs. rest, routines, mood, learning, and safety.
- Use fewer medical details.
- Use drawings or matching activities.

High School

- Include circadian rhythm, caffeine, screens, academic workload, driving safety, and mental health support.
- Use scenario analysis and goal-setting.

Adult Education

- Include shift work, caregiving, parenting, stress, chronic health issues, and realistic sleep planning.
- Avoid school-only examples.
- Emphasize flexible strategies.

C. Teacher Language Bank

Use these phrases to keep the lesson compassionate and accurate:

- "Sleep is a health need, not a character test."
- "Rest helps, but sleep performs unique biological work."
- "Naps can be useful, but they are not a full replacement for regular adequate sleep."
- "Some sleep barriers are habit-based; others are life-based or medical."
- "If sleep problems are ongoing, severe, or unsafe, support is appropriate."

- "You do not have to share personal information to learn from this lesson."
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16. QRU Lesson Summary for Teachers

The QRU standard for this lesson is clarity without shame.

Learners should leave understanding that:

- Sleep is biologically necessary.
 - Rest and relaxation are useful but different from sleep.
 - Naps may help alertness but do not fully replace regular adequate nighttime sleep.
 - Sleep supports learning, memory, mood, immune function, metabolism, cardiovascular health, recovery, and safety.
 - Recommended sleep ranges vary by age.
 - Sleep habits can improve sleep for many people.
 - Some sleep problems are connected to medical, mental health, environmental, work, caregiving, trauma, or housing factors.
 - Ongoing or serious sleep problems should be discussed with a qualified professional.
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17. Sources

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2. Paruthi S, Brooks LJ, D'Ambrosio C, et al. "Recommended Amount of Sleep for Pediatric Populations: A Consensus Statement of the American Academy of Sleep Medicine." *Journal of Clinical Sleep Medicine*. 2016.
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4. National Heart, Lung, and Blood Institute. "Sleep Deprivation and Deficiency." <https://www.nhlbi.nih.gov/health/sleep-deprivation>
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